

BEFORE THE STATE BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR EXAMINERS

STATE OF COLORADO

Case No. 2022-2411

STIPULATION AND FINAL AGENCY ORDER

IN THE MATTER OF DISCIPLINARY PROCEEDINGS REGARDING THE LICENSE TO PRACTICE AS A PROFESSIONAL COUNSELOR IN THE STATE OF COLORADO OF ELIZABETH ANN RUPE, LICENSE NO. LPC.0016377,

Respondent.

IT IS HEREBY STIPULATED by and between the State Board of Licensed Professional Counselor Examiners (the "Board") and Elizabeth Anne Rupe ("Respondent") as follows:

1. The Board has jurisdiction over the person of Respondent and the subject matter of this Stipulation and Final Agency Order ("Order").

2. Respondent was licensed to practice as a professional counselor ("LPC") in the State of Colorado on July 22, 2020, having been issued license number LPC.0016377, and is currently so licensed.

3. This Order is a full and final resolution of case number 2022-2411. This Order does not resolve any other cases, complaints, or matters, known or unknown to the Board or Respondent, as of the effective date of this Order.

4. Respondent admits the following:

a. Respondent failed to act within the limitations created by a physical illness, physical condition, or behavioral, mental health, or substance use disorder that renders the person unable to treat clients with reasonable skill and safety or that may endanger the health or safety of persons under his or her care.

5. By virtue of the facts admitted in paragraph 4 above, Respondent admits and the Board finds that Respondent violated section 12-245-224(1)(f)(II), C.R.S., which states:

12-245-224. Prohibited activities--related provisions. (1) A person licensed, registered, or certified under this article 245 violates this article 245 if he or she:

(f)(II) Fails to act within the limitations created by a physical illness, physical condition, or behavioral, mental health, or substance use disorder that renders the person unable to treat clients with reasonable skill and safety or that may endanger the health or safety of persons under his or her care.

6. By virtue of the admissions in paragraphs 4 and 5 above, Respondent is subject to the following disciplinary sanction that the Board believes is necessary to protect the public health, safety, and welfare.

RELINQUISHMENT

7. Respondent hereby relinquishes her license in the State of Colorado, commencing from the effective date of this Order, and requests that the Board accept said relinquishment. Such relinquishment shall have the same force and effect as a revocation ordered by the Board, including the provisions of section 12-20-404(3), C.R.S.

8. Following relinquishment of her Colorado license, Respondent shall not perform any act requiring a license to practice in the state of Colorado.

9. Respondent understands that if she applies for licensure as a professional counselor in the state of Colorado at any future time, Respondent will be required to comply with all criteria for initial license that exist at the time of application.

10. Respondent also agrees not to perform any act constituting psychotherapy in the state of Colorado as defined under section 12-245-202(14), C.R.S.

TERMS AND CONDITIONS

11. Respondent is fully aware of and understands the right to receive a formal notice of hearing and charges and to have a formal disciplinary hearing, pursuant to sections 12-20-403 and 12-245-226, C.R.S., and hereby waives those rights. Further, Respondent also acknowledges that this waiver constitutes a waiver of all rights to appeal in this matter.

12. This Order is entered into by Respondent voluntarily and without coercion, after an opportunity to consult with counsel and with full understanding of the legal consequences of this Order and the right to formal hearing on all matters herein.

13. This Order shall become an order of the Board when it is accepted and signed by the Program Director or authorized Board representative.

14. The Order entered pursuant to this Stipulation and Final Agency Order shall constitute a Board order for purposes of section 12-245-224, C.R.S., and shall have the same force and effect as an order entered after a formal disciplinary hearing pursuant to sections 12-20-403, 12-245-214, 12-245-226, and 24-4-104(9), C.R.S.

15. Respondent acknowledges and agrees that any violation of this Order shall constitute a violation of a lawful Board Order and be grounds for further proceedings pursuant to the Mental Health Practice Act and, if proven, may constitute a basis for further disciplinary action. The pendency of any disciplinary action shall not affect the obligation of Respondent to comply with the terms of this Order, and this Order shall remain operative and in full force and effect.

16. Respondent shall obey all state and federal laws while this Order is in effect.

17. This Order constitutes the entire agreement between Respondent and the Board. There are no other promises expressed or implied. In the event that any provision of this Order is deemed unenforceable by a court of competent jurisdiction, such provision shall be severed, and the remainder of this Order shall be given full force and effect.

18. This Order shall become effective upon (a) mailing by first-class mail to Respondent at Respondent's address of record with the Board, or (b) service by electronic means on Respondent at Respondent's electronic address of record with the Board. Respondent hereby consents to service by electronic means if Respondent has an electronic address on file with the Board.

19. This Order shall be admissible as evidence at any hearing held before the Board.

20. This Order shall be a public record in the custody of the Board.

AGREED TO AND ACCEPTED BY:

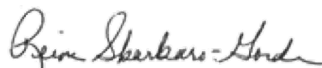
RESPONDENT



ELIZABETH ANN RUPE,
LICENSE NO. LPC.0016377

AGREED TO AND ORDERED BY:

STATE BOARD OF LICENSED PROFESSIONAL
COUNSELOR EXAMINERS



REINA SBARBARO-GORDON
Program Director

Effective this 6th day of March,
2023.